

GDC Production Manager

Complete guide: installation, features explained, examples,
troubleshooting

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Guide updated for the current app version

1. What is GDC Production Manager

GDC Production Manager is a standalone desktop app for managing video production projects — films, ads, weddings, documentaries, broadcast, music videos, corporate work. Each user installs it on their own laptop; data stays 100% local, nothing goes online without your say-so.

Technically, the app starts a local server (Flask + SQLite) and automatically opens the interface in a browser tab, at an address like `http://127.0.0.1:xxxx` — it looks and works like a website, but runs entirely on your computer, no account, no subscription, no mandatory cloud.

What it can do

- Track projects through all their stages: planning → shooting → editing → grading → review → final → delivered.
- Keep track of clients, 1-on-1 courses, and digital products (DCTLs, LUTs, presets) you sell.
- Reusable checklists per project, reminders for deadlines and invoices, monthly calendar.
- PDF reports, JSON export/import for backup, light/dark theme.
- Full interface in Romanian, English, and Spanish.

What it doesn't do

- It's not a remote multi-user cloud system — sync between laptops is optional and self-hosted, not through a third-party server.
- It doesn't issue official tax invoices — invoicing in the app is simple, for your own tracking (budget, amount received, status).
- No Linux version currently — Mac and Windows only.

Note: The app is free and open-source (MIT license) — full source code is available on GitHub.

2. Installation

macOS

Download GDCProductionManager.pkg from the Releases page. Double-click the file and follow the standard macOS installer steps — same as any regular Mac app.

Windows

Download GDCProductionManager.exe from the Releases page. Double-click to run directly — no separate installation needed.

On first launch

The app automatically opens the interface in a new browser tab, at a local address (<http://127.0.0.1:xxxx>). If the browser doesn't open automatically, check the address shown in the app window and copy it manually into a browser.

Note: Your data (projects, clients, etc.) is saved locally, in a SQLite database on your computer. Do a periodic JSON export (from Settings) as a backup, especially before switching laptops.

3. Every feature, explained in detail

Projects and pipeline stages

Every project has a type (film, ad, wedding, documentary, broadcast, music video, corporate), shoot location, and shoot/delivery dates. The stages are fixed and clear: planning → shooting → editing → grading → review → final → delivered.

The "Next Step" button automatically advances the project to the next stage, with a visual bar showing overall project progress at a glance. Each stage keeps its own notes field, separate from the others — shooting notes don't mix with editing notes.

Clients

A client registry with contact details and the number of projects/courses linked to each — see your recurring clients at a glance.

1-on-1 courses

If you teach individual sessions (grading, editing, etc.), each course has a topic, date/time, duration, price, payment status, course status (scheduled/confirmed/completed/cancelled), and location (online/in-person) — linked to the relevant client.

Digital products

For anyone selling DCTLs, PowerGrades, LUTs, presets or templates: every product has price, version, compatibility, local path and download link — a centralized list of everything you sell.

Selectable currency (EUR / RON)

Every project, course, or product can have its own currency. Dashboard totals are tracked SEPARATELY per currency — not mixed into one misleading figure.

Checklists and templates

Per-project checklists (pre-shoot, post-shoot, or custom), with checkable items and a progress bar (percentage + X of Y). Four default templates come included automatically (pre/post-shoot wedding, pre/post-shoot ad), fully editable or deletable like any other.

Reminders and notifications

Standalone reminders for deadlines, unpaid invoices, or meetings. The app checks on launch and every 15 minutes for upcoming deadlines — in-app notifications plus native browser notifications (if you grant permission).

Calendar and .ics export

Monthly calendar with shoots and deliveries. You can export reminders, upcoming courses, and delivery dates as an .ics file, importable into Apple Calendar, Outlook, or Google Calendar.

PDF reports

Per-project and per-checklist reports, printable directly from the app — useful for client delivery or archiving.

Optional self-hosted sync

If you work from two laptops, you can sync data between the two installations, without a third-party server — you fully control where the data goes.

Local multi-user

Multiple accounts can exist on the same laptop, each with its own data, completely separate from each other.

4. Practical usage examples

New project from scratch

- Add new project → pick the type (e.g. wedding) → fill in client, shoot/delivery dates, currency.
- Apply the "Pre-shoot Wedding" checklist template — comes pre-populated with standard items.
- As you progress, click "Next Step" at each completed stage — the progress bar updates automatically.
- At the end, generate the PDF report and hand it to the client.

Managing a 1-on-1 course

- Add the course with topic, date/time, price, and the linked client.
- Update the payment status as you receive it.
- The dashboard automatically shows you this week's courses and monthly course revenue, split by currency.

Backup before a new laptop

- Settings → Export JSON — save the file somewhere safe (personal cloud, USB).
- On the new laptop, install the app, then Settings → Import JSON.
- All projects, clients, courses, and products come back exactly as they were.

5. Common issues and solutions

The app doesn't open the browser automatically

- Check the app window — the local address (`http://127.0.0.1:xxxx`) is shown there. Copy it manually into a browser.
- A firewall or antivirus can temporarily block the local server — check your security settings if the problem persists.

Lost data after a reinstall

- Data is local, in the SQLite database — a clean reinstall may not preserve it if you also deleted the data folder.
- This is why periodic JSON export from Settings matters, before any major reinstall or laptop switch.

Native browser notifications don't show up

- The browser requires explicit permission for notifications — check whether you accepted it when asked.
- In-app notifications (toasts) work independently, even if browser permission was denied.

Dashboard totals look off

- Check whether you have projects/courses in different currencies — totals are calculated separately for EUR and RON, not mixed. What looks like a "small" sum may just be one of the two currencies.

Sync between two laptops isn't working

- Self-hosted sync requires both installations to be able to communicate directly (usually the same local network) — check network settings if the laptops are on different networks.

6. License

GDC Production Manager is MIT licensed — free, open-source, full source code available on GitHub. You can use, modify, and redistribute it freely.

The app uses Flask and SQLAlchemy (Python backend), both under permissive (BSD) licenses, and is distributed via PyInstaller.